

23 Which statement is correct?

- A** Ethanol has a larger pK_a value than phenol because the ethoxide ion is more stable than the phenoxide ion.
- B** Ethanol has a smaller pK_a value than water because of the electron-donating effect of the ethyl group in the ethoxide ion.
- C** Phenol has a larger K_a value than water because a lone pair of electrons on the oxygen atom is drawn into the delocalised electron ring system.
- D** Phenol has a smaller K_a value than ethanol because it is a stronger acid than ethanol.